

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

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Report Name: Venezuela Agricultural Imports Grow 9 Percent in 2024 with the United States among Leading Suppliers

Country: Venezuela

Post: Caracas

Report Category: Agricultural Situation, Grain and Feed, Oilseeds and Products, Agriculture in the Economy

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Report Highlights:

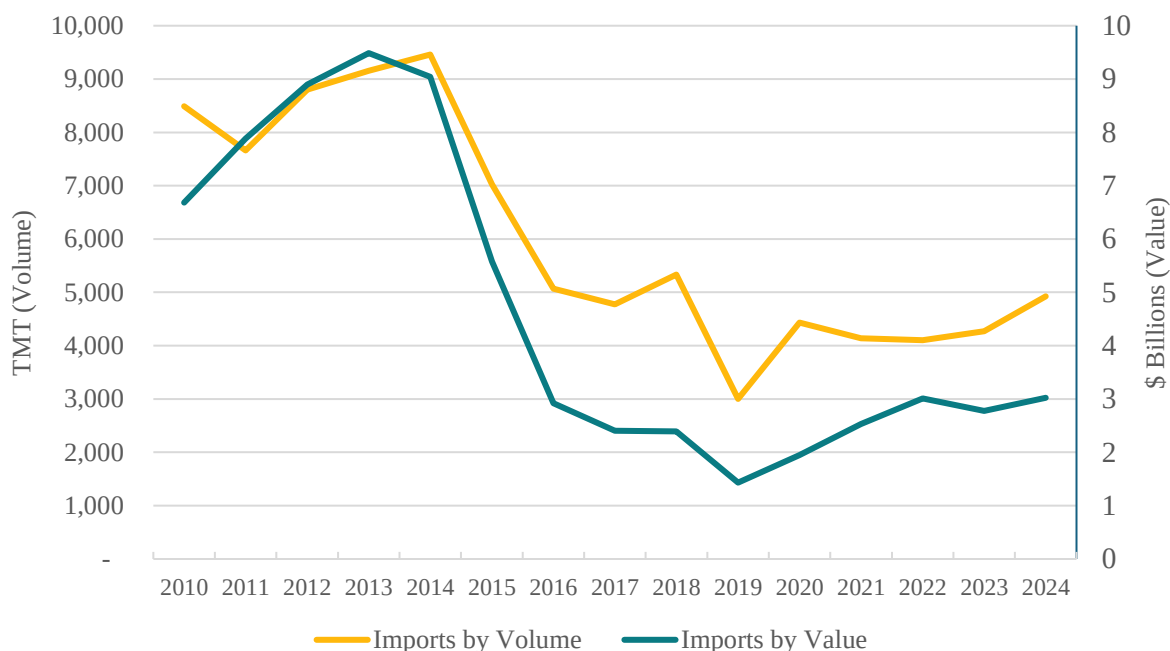
Venezuelan agricultural imports in 2024 grew 9 percent year-on-year to \$3 billion. Agricultural imports experienced a 15 percent year-on-year increase in volume, driven by rising demand and a slight reduction in import prices. Agricultural imports from the United States totaled \$800 million, an increase of 19 percent year on year and the highest level since 2014. The primary U.S. agricultural exports to Venezuela included soybean meal, corn, wheat, soybeans, rice, and various consumer products. The United States remained the second-largest exporter of agricultural products to Venezuela, with a 26 percent market share, second to Brazil.

Summary

In 2024, the Venezuelan economy grew by 4 percent, mirroring 2023. This growth was supported by increased oil revenues, a stable exchange rate, and reduced inflation (85 percent in 2024 compared to 181 percent in 2023) throughout the third quarter. The decline in inflation, coupled with modest increases in real wages, led to an estimated 5 percent rise in private consumption. This moderate growth in consumption allowed Venezuela's agricultural sector, particularly the poultry industry, to boost production and grow demand in both domestic and imported raw materials.

Last year, agricultural exports to Venezuela increased by 9 percent year-on-year to \$3 billion, while trade volumes rose by 15 percent to 4.9 million metric tons (Figure 1). Since hitting its 2019 historic lows, Venezuelan agricultural imports have surged by 111 percent in value and 65 percent in volume. Agricultural imports significantly enhanced Venezuela's food availability, recovered faster than domestic production, and support approximately 60 percent of Venezuela's total food supply.

Figure 1. Venezuela Agricultural Imports Measure by Value and Volume, 2010-2024
(Thousand Metric Tons [TMT], USD Billions)



Data source: Trade Data Monitor (TDM).

Venezuelan Agricultural Imports in 2024

In 2024, Venezuelan agricultural imports grew by 9 percent to \$3 billion, with volumes rising 15 percent to 4.9 million metric tons, aided by a 6.4 percent decline in average import prices (Tables 1, 2, and 4). Major agricultural suppliers by value were Brazil (29 percent), the United States (26 percent), and Türkiye (7 percent) (Table 4). By volume, the United States held a 39 percent share, Brazil 28 percent, and Türkiye 7 percent (Table 5).

Table 1. Venezuela Agricultural Imports by Value, Category 2023 vs. 2024 (USD Millions)

Category	2023	2024	Change %	% 2024 Market Share Value
Bulk	836	858	3	28
Intermediate	1,025	1,048	2	35
Consumer	849	1,014	19	34
Ag Related	65	101	54	3
Total	2,775	3,022	9	28

Table 2. Venezuela Agricultural Import Volumes by Category 2023 vs. 2024 (TMT)

Category	2023	2024	Change %	% 2023 Market Share Volume
Bulk	2,401	2,814	17	57
Intermediate	1,380	1,599	16	32
Consumer	469	484	3	10
Ag Related	19	28	46	1
Total	4,270	4,925	15	-

Table 3. Average Price Changes of Venezuelan Agricultural Imports 2023 vs. 2024 (USD/MT)

Category	2023	2024	Change %
Bulk	348.0	304.8	(12.4)
Intermediate	725.2	642.2	(11.5)
Consumer	1,685.3	1,901.9	12.9
Ag Related	2,833.8	3,148.8	11.1
All Agricultural Products	628.1	587.7	(6.4)

Note: Data includes agricultural products traded in metric tons (MT).

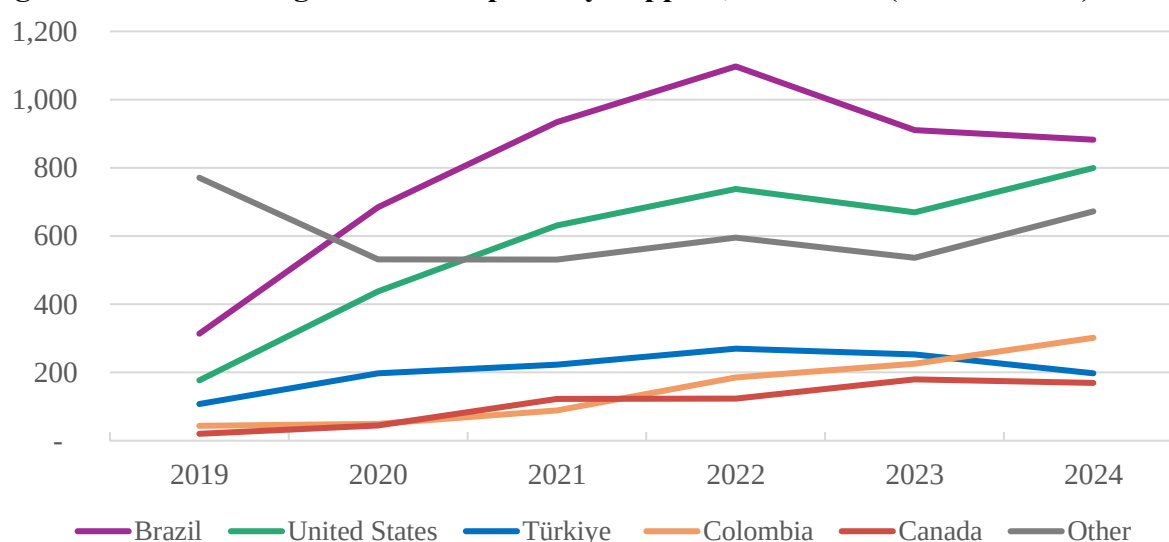
Table 4. Value of Venezuela Agricultural Imports by Origin 2023 vs. 2024 (USD Millions)

Country	2023	2024	Change %	% 2024 Market Share by Value
Brazil	911	882	(3)	29
USA	670	799	19	26
Türkiye	253	197	(22)	7
Colombia	226	302	34	10
Canada	180	169	(6)	6
All Others	536	672	25	22
Total	2,775	3,022	9	-

Table 5. Volume of Venezuelan Agricultural Imports by Origin 2023 vs. 2024 (TMT)

Country	2023	2024	Change %	% 2024 Market Share by Volume
USA	1,241	1,901	53	39
Brazil	1,396	1,379	(1)	28
Türkiye	419	334	(20)	7
Canada	471	518	10	11
Argentina	283	345	22	7
Other	461	449	(2)	9
Total	4,270	4,925	15	-

Figure 2. Venezuela: Agricultural Imports by Supplier, 2019-2024 (USD Millions)



Data Source for Tables 1-5, Figure 2: Trade Data Monitor (TDM).

Since 2019, Venezuelan agricultural imports have increased by 111 percent in value and 65 percent in volume, driven by economic liberalization, the end of hyperinflation, and greater private sector involvement in trade. Countries with the largest increases in export volumes to Venezuela included Canada (612 percent), the United States (364 percent), Argentina (270 percent), Brazil (126 percent), and Türkiye (47 percent).

From 2019 to 2024, intermediate product¹ imports saw the largest volume increase at 99 percent, followed by consumer products at 98 percent, and bulk products at 45 percent. In 2024, bulk and intermediate products grew the most by volume, at 17 and 16 percent, respectively, while consumer products grew 3 percent. Since 2022, Venezuela has gradually reduced its consumer product imports and increased bulk and intermediate product imports to support Venezuela's food processing industry.

When measured by value, the largest imported products in 2024 were corn, soybean meal, dairy products, wheat, sugars, soybean oil, pasta, rice, food preparations, and pulses, accounting for 67 percent of total imports (Table 6). By volume, top imports included corn, wheat, soybean meal, rice, sugars, milled grains, pasta, soybean oil, pulses, and soybeans, and comprised 91 percent of total imports (Table 7). Significant volume increases were seen in pulses (143 percent), corn (39 percent), and sugars (39 percent), while decreases observed in rice (-34 percent), pasta (-22 percent), and milled grains (-10 percent).

¹ Partially processed agricultural goods that serve as inputs for further manufacturing into final consumer products and found in various chapters of the U.S. Harmonized Tariff Schedule. For Venezuela, intermediate products include, but are not limited to, soybean meal, soybean oil, essential oils, planting seeds, dextrin and proteins, and live animals.

Table 6. Venezuela: Top Imported Agricultural Products by Value with U.S. Market Share, 2023-2024 (USD Millions)

Product	2023	2024	% Change	% U.S. Market Share
Corn	261	306	17	48
Soybean Meal	333	297	(11)	100
Dairy Products	175	237	36	6
Wheat	254	234	(8)	30
Sugars	162	214	32	0
Soybean Oil	185	190	3	25
Pasta & Products	211	168	(21)	4
Rice	211	152	(28)	54
Food Preparations	108	127	18	24
Pulses	45	106	134	2
Total	1,944	2,030	4	34

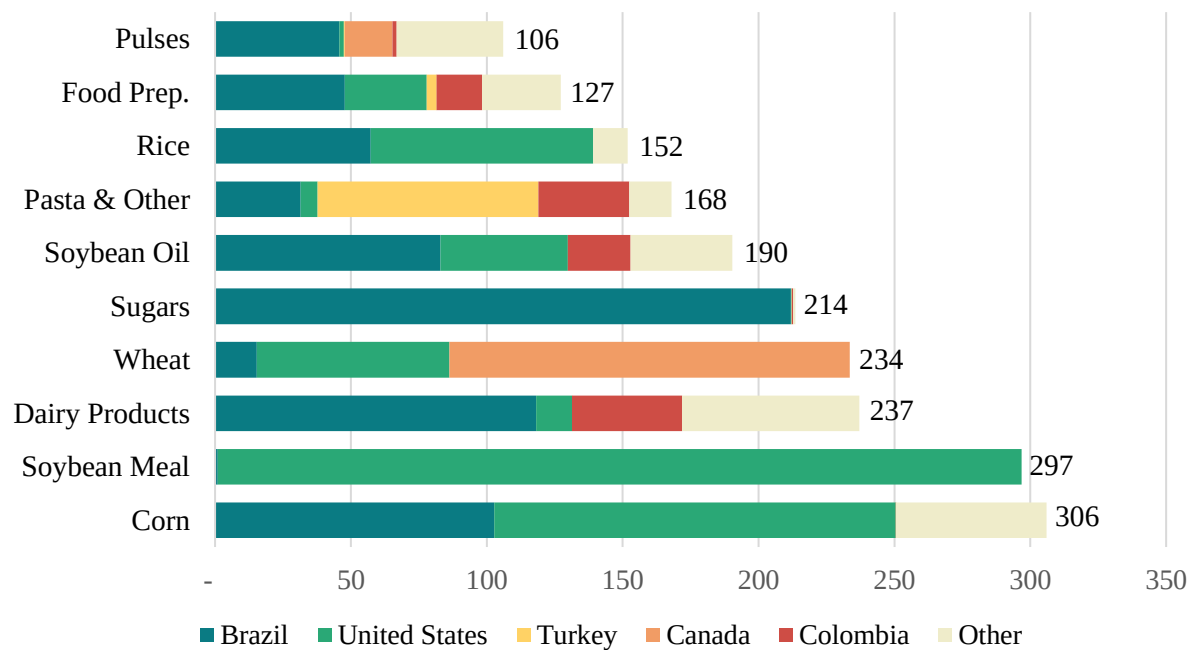
Table 7. Venezuela: Top Imported Agricultural Products by Volume with U.S. Market Share 2023-2024 (TMT)

Product	2023	2024	% Change	% U.S. Market Share
Corn	1,009	1,406	39	44
Wheat	733	831	13	32
Soybean Meal	635	712	12	100
Rice	496	327	(34)	52
Sugars	274	381	39	0
Milled Grains	255	230	(10)	0
Pasta & Products	247	193	(22)	1
Soybean Oil	133	174	31	28
Pulses	54	132	143	1
Soybeans	96	106	10	56
Total	3,933	4,492	14	42

Data Source for Tables 6 and 7: TDM.

Last year, the United States held significant market shares by value among primary agricultural export categories, including soybean meal (99 percent), corn (28 percent), wheat (25 percent), and rice (15 percent).

Figure 3. Venezuela: Top Products Exported to Venezuela by Origin, 2024 (USD Millions)

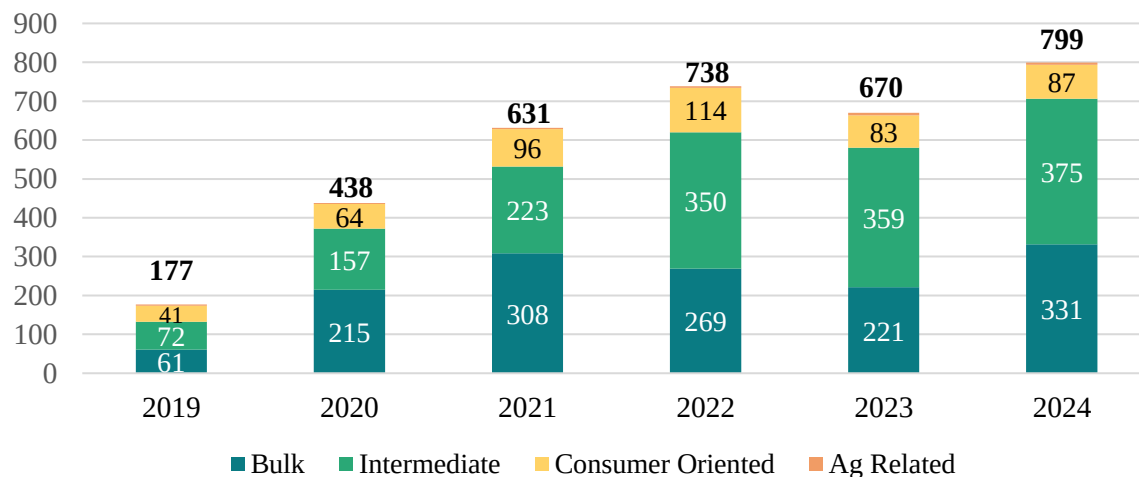


Data source: TDM, with Post analysis.

Venezuelan Agricultural Imports from the United States

In 2024, the United States was Venezuela's largest supplier of agricultural products by volume, with 1.9 million MT (39 percent market share), growing 53 percent (Table 9). It was also the second largest supplier by value, rising 19 percent to \$799 million (26 percent market share) (Table 8).

Figure 4. U.S. Agricultural Exports to Venezuela by Category 2019–2024 (USD millions)



Data source: TDM.

**Table 8. U.S. Ag Exports to Venezuela
2023 vs. 2024 (USD Millions)**

Category	2023	2024	Chg %
Bulk	221	331	50
Intermediate	359	375	4
Consumer	83	87	5
Ag Related	6	6	(1)
Total	670	799	19

Data sources: TDM.

**Table 9. U.S. Ag Exports to Venezuela
2023 vs. 2024 (TMT)**

Category	2023	2024	Chg %
Bulk	583	1,109	90
Intermediate	634	769	21
Consumer	22	21	(<1)
Ag Related	2	1	(76)
Total	1,241	1,901	53

Between 2019 and 2024, agricultural trade from the United States to Venezuela increased by 352 percent in value and 364 percent in volume. Last year, most products consisted in both bulk and intermediate items, which provided essential food and feed ingredients for Venezuela's domestic animal feed processors and food industries. These products included soybean meal and oil, corn, rice, and wheat, which accounted for 80 percent of total exports by value (Table 10).

**Table 10. Top Five U.S. Products
Exported to Venezuela, 2023 vs. 2024
(USD Millions)**

Product	2023	2024	Chg %
Soybean Meal	328	296	(10)
Corn	74	148	100
Rice	33	82	146
Wheat	62	71	14
Soybean Oil	0	47	-
Total	498	643	21

Data sources: Trade Data Monitor

**Table 11. Top Five U.S. Products Exported
to Venezuela, 2023 vs. 2024 (TMT)**

Product	2023	2024	Chg %
Soybean Meal	623	710	14
Corn	243	613	153
Rice	77	169	119
Wheat	172	265	54
Soybean Oil	0	49	-
Total	1,116	1,806	62

Venezuela's imports of U.S. corn and soybean meal by volume increased by 153 percent and 14 percent year-on-year, respectively, due to competitive pricing and higher feed demand to support the recovering poultry industry. Similarly, imports of U.S. rice, wheat, and soybean oil increased significantly, also driven by competitive prices (Table 11) and improved economic conditions to support imports.² The average price of the top five U.S. products exported to Venezuela dropped 20 percent year-on-year through December 2024 (Table 12). In 2024, Venezuela was the 33rd largest market for U.S. agricultural exports. Venezuela ranked sixth in U.S. soybean meal, 10th in rice, 13th in corn, and 19th in wheat, highlighting its importance as a critical market for the United States.

² Venezuelan private sector importers with strong U.S. affiliation also benefitted from an increase in available foreign exchange (U.S. dollars) as agricultural goods are exempt from U.S. Department of the Treasury trade sanctions.

Table 12. Price Changes of Top U.S. Products to Venezuela, 2023 vs. 2024 (USD/MT)

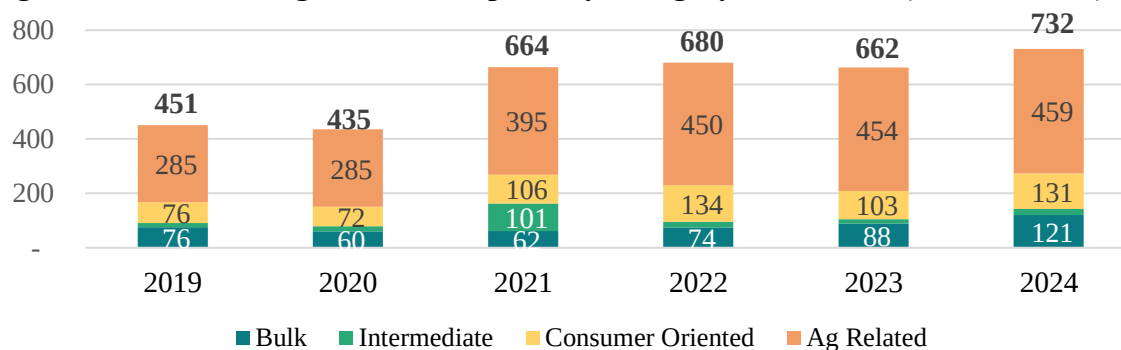
Product	Average Import Price 2023	Average Import Price 2024	Change %
Soybean Meal	526.7	416.8	(20.9)
Corn	303.7	240.9	(20.7)
Rice	430.1	483.3	12.4
Wheat	361.4	267.4	(26.0)
Soybean Oil	1,479.6	965.5	(34.7)

Data source: TDM, with Post analysis.

Venezuela Agricultural Exports

Venezuelan agricultural exports have grown 62 percent since 2019, driven mainly by increased exports of seafood, distilled spirits, cacao, chocolate products, forest products, and pulses (dry beans).

Venezuelan agricultural exports totaled \$732 million for 2024, growing 10 percent year-on-year (Table 13). Primary markets included the European Union (42 percent market share), the United States (24 percent), and China (7 percent). Agricultural commodity trade is the most critical segment of non-petroleum exports in Venezuela. Venezuelan agricultural exports to the United States totaled \$173 million last year, rising 27 percent from 2023 (Table 14). The main product category for the U.S. market was seafood, comprising 60 percent of total trade. This included blue crab, shrimp, tuna, and frozen fish products.

Figure 5. Venezuela: Agricultural Exports by Category, 2019–2024 (USD Millions)

Data source: TDM.

Table 13. Venezuela Agricultural Exports by Product, 2019-2024 (USD Million)

Product	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	Change % 2019-2024
Seafood Products	267	271	362	417	429	423	58
Cocoa Beans	46	33	36	32	31	69	50
Distilled Spirits	58	53	76	99	67	65	11
Chocolate & Cocoa Products	7	6	10	11	14	36	380
Forest Products	17	13	33	33	25	36	107
Other Products	55	59	147	88	96	103	86
Total	451	435	664	680	662	732	62

Table 14. Venezuelan Agricultural Exports to the United States, 2023-2024 (USD Millions)

Product	2023	2024	Change %
Seafood Products	104	104	(0)
Distilled Spirits	7	16	129
Chocolate & Cocoa Products	5	15	194
Coffee, Unroasted	2	10	448
Bakery Goods, Cereals, & Pasta	6	10	70
Other	13	19	47
Total	136	173	27

Data source for Tables 13, 14 and Figure 5: TDM.

Near Term Outlook

Venezuela's GDP is projected to contract by 2-4 percent in 2025, reversing previous recovery from 2021-2024. This downturn is due to renewed petroleum and gas sanctions and a weak global oil market, leading to decreased oil export revenues. The like consequences include accelerated currency depreciation and high inflation, estimated in the three-digit range for 2025. Inflation and a shrinking private labor market may reduce private consumption by up to 5 percent. Although food availability has improved since 2019, the expected decline in purchasing power will likely affect food consumption, especially animal proteins, which remain below historical averages.

The predicted economic decline and foreign exchange shortage may reduce agricultural imports by 10 to 15 percent. This will heavily affect imports of consumer products and moderately affect bulk and intermediate products. Although U.S. exports will also see a decline, the impact will be minimal as nearly 90 percent of Venezuela's agricultural imports are bulk and intermediate goods, much of it in high demand by the animal feed industries. The United States will remain a key supplier of agricultural products to Venezuela with strong market share in soybeans, corn, rice, and wheat. The U.S. retains competitive advantages in price, quality, and geographical proximity, which can enhance its market share, especially in bulk and intermediate goods.

For more information on exporting to Venezuela, please see the [FAS 2025 Food and Agricultural Import Regulations and Standards \(FAIRS\) Country Report](#) and [Exporter Guide](#).³

Attachments:

No Attachments.

³ The FAS Exporter Guide for 2025 will be published in July of this year.